The 3-minute pitch

PART 1 The story

0:00 — 1:00

> *Stand still. Hands down. Do not rush a single line of this. The whole pitch is built on the pauses, and this is where you earn them.*

OPEN SLOW

"This happens somewhere in India every monsoon.

Two teams. Two hills. Eight hundred metres of open air between them.

They can see each other. They wave.

PAUSE · 1

STAKES

On one hill, a woman is trapped under a concrete slab. On the other hill is the only man with the cutting gear.

And there is no way to tell him.

The mobile tower went in the first hour. The satellite phone is with the district officer, three kilometres away. The walkie-talkies reach the ridge and stop.

So a nineteen-year-old volunteer runs. Down one hill. Up the other.

PAUSE · 2

THE NUMBER

Twenty-two minutes.

PAUSE · 3 — HOLD IT LONGER

LAND IT

The message he carried was four words long. *Survivor. Concrete slab. Hurry.*

Four words. Twenty-two minutes.

And every single person on both of those hills was holding a phone — charged, working, and completely useless. Because the only thing it knew how to do was reach a tower that wasn't there."

> *That last sentence is the bridge. It turns a sad story into the reason your product exists — so do not drop your voice at the end of it.*

Why ISRO asked

PART 2

The problem statement

1:00 — 1:45

Change of pace here — brisker, factual, confident. This is the section that proves you actually read the problem statement instead of skimming it.

BRISK

"This is ISRO's problem statement — SIH26173. And it turns on one sentence.

ISRO says the message must be *spoken*, not written — because it has to work for someone who cannot read. In a disaster, that is a lot of people.

And in the very next breath: audio is far too heavy for a weak link.

PAUSE · 4

THE CONTRA-DICTION

That is a contradiction. Voice is the only fair medium. Voice is the one thing the link cannot carry.

And you cannot fix it with a better codec. Opus is the best in the world — it stops working below six thousand bits per second. A degraded emergency link gives you three hundred.

You are twenty times short before you write a single line of code.

PAUSE · 5

HAND OFF

So ISRO isn't asking for compression. ISRO is asking you to stop sending the voice — and send the *meaning*."

Say "meaning, not voice" exactly as written. If you forget every other line in this pitch, that is the one idea the jury must leave the room holding.

The numbers in this section, and where they come from

Opus floor ≈ 6 kbps	The codec's own published lower bound — it is a limit of the codec, not a gap in our engineering.
Link ≈ 300 bps	The low-bitrate link the problem statement is written for.
"Twenty times short"	6,000 ÷ 300 = 20. Safe to say out loud; safe if a judge does the division.

How we solve it

PART 3 The solve, and the payoff

1:45 — 3:00

Both phones in your hand from the very first word of this section. Do not pick them up halfway through — the jury should see them before you start talking.

FAST CLEAR

"That is exactly what iTantra does. Three steps. All on the handset. Nothing in the cloud — not one line.

One. You hold the button and speak. A speech model runs on the phone itself and writes down what you said. In your language.

Two. We don't send the audio. We don't even send the text. Both phones carry the same table of emergency sentences, in all ten languages — so we send the *row number*.

Three. The other phone looks up that row in *its own* language, and speaks it out loud. Odia goes in. Hindi comes out. No translation model anywhere — the shared table *is* the translation, and it was written by humans, in advance, so it cannot mistranslate under pressure.

PAUSE · 6 — THEN SLOW RIGHT DOWN

THE PAYOFF

Which means those four words on that hillside — *survivor, concrete slab, hurry* — are thirteen bytes.

Thirteen. Bytes.

PAUSE · 7

PROOF

Sixteen hundred times smaller than the audio. Forty-three times smaller than Opus at its floor. Ten languages, and the whole app is twenty-seven megabytes.

And there is no pairing — it rides Bluetooth advertisements, so any phone with the app open is already on the network. Out of range? The next phone relays it. Three hops.

Hold both phones up now. Screens facing the jury. Wait until they are actually looking at them before the last three lines.

CLOSE

Both of these are in aeroplane mode. No SIM. No tower. No internet.

Twenty-two minutes, or one second. Watch."

Delivery & guard rails

The three beats that win it

- **"They can see each other. They wave."** — your strongest line. It makes the failure *visible*. Do not hurry it.
- **"Twenty times short before you write a single line of code."** — where a technical jury decides you understand the problem.
- **"Thirteen. Bytes."** — two separate sentences. The callback that pays off the story, and the line they will repeat to each other afterwards.

If you get cut to 60 seconds

Two hills → "twenty-two minutes" → "twenty times short" → "thirteen bytes" → phones up

Three things not to say

1 · No latency or accuracy numbers

Not measured yet — the app refuses to produce the results file until a release build has run thirty minutes, off charge, over a hundred sentences. **If asked:** "Instrumented on the live path, but not yet soaked to our own reporting standard — I won't quote a figure I can't reproduce." That scores better than a number you cannot defend.

2 · Never "we have no internet permission"

The app does declare it — Android requires it to open any socket, including a broadcast one. **Say instead:** "No web code anywhere in the app, no address ever looked up, every packet addressed to everyone nearby. And here it is in aeroplane mode."

3 · Seven of ten speak, not ten

All ten are recognised and displayed; seven are also spoken aloud. Tamil, Kannada and Odia have no freely licensed voice small enough for a phone. Naming it first costs far less than being caught by it.

Questions you will be asked

"Is that story real?"	It opens with "this happens every monsoon" — representative of these events, not a report of one incident. Said that way it is honest, and it holds.
"Your worst language?"	Odia — smallest published corpus, and one of the three with no free voice. Which is why a table-coded alert still arrives *spoken* in Odia: the sending phone did the recognising.
"Why not just a codec?"	Opus bottoms out at 6 kbps; the link is 300 bps. A bound of the codec, not an engineering gap — and we are still 43× under that floor.
"If the recogniser is wrong?"	Confidence is on screen and on the wire. The sender sees the text before it goes. Alerts need a second confirming press.

If your mind goes blank, say this

"We stopped trying to squeeze the voice down the wire. We send the meaning — and the phone at the other end says it out loud, in that listener's own language."